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CIN : U62099RJ2025OPC100267

## Department Wise Audit Report

# MENA & International Sales

Distributor Relations, Cross-Border Ops & Pipeline — Neha Pathak

An independent operational review of the MENA & International Sales vertical, evaluating cross-border logistics dependencies, manual remittance workflows, and pipeline visibility constraints, prepared as part of the EF Polymer Private Limited organization-wide operational audit by Creative Upaay (brand owned by Cinnovate Solutions (OPC) Private Limited).

|                  |                            |
|------------------|----------------------------|
| CLIENT           | EF Polymer Private Limited |
| PREPARED BY      | Creative Upaay             |
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| REVIEW SCOPE     | MENA & International Sales |



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## SECTION 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# Report Overview — MENA & International

Scope, current state, and headline findings

The MENA & International Sales vertical manages B2B distributor relationships across Asia, Africa, and Australia. Operating as a distributor/importer-led model, the vertical is led by Neha Pathak, who acts as the single point of contact (SPOC) for all international customers.

The audit identified three compounding structural failures: a **single-point logistics constraint** sharing one manager with domestic ops, a **manual cross-border remittance workflow** requiring BD to warn Accounts before dispatch, and **international client data trapped on personal SIMs/WeChat**. Furthermore, the pipeline is managed entirely in disconnected Google Sheets with no CRM visibility for the COO. The vertical scores 2.0 maturity against a target of 3.1.

|                                      |                                        |                                        |                                           |                                               |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>2–4 mo</b><br>TRIAL CROP<br>CYCLE | <b>~90%</b><br>PO DATA<br>COMPLETENESS | <b>1 week</b><br>MIN. DISPATCH<br>PREP | <b>100%</b><br>SPOC ROUTING<br>DEPENDENCY | <b>2.0 / 5.0</b><br>OVERALL<br>MATURITY SCORE |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|

### About the Maturity Score

A 1–5 scale measuring how systematised, documented, and independently operable the vertical is. Scored across five dimensions: Process, Technology, Data Quality, Documentation & Knowledge Management.

1 — Ad hoc ————— 5 — Optimised

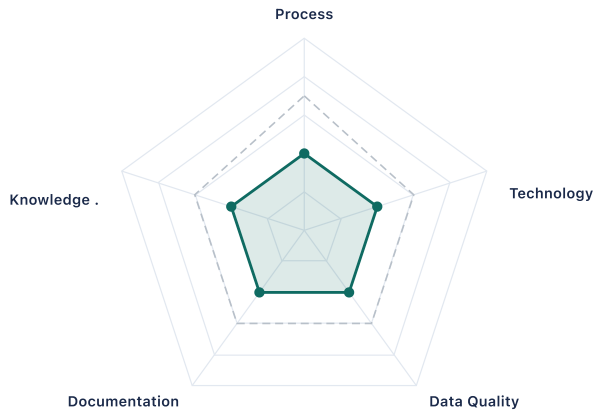
■ **2.0** Current state   ■ **3.1** Post-roadmap target   ○ **5.0** Best-in-class benchmark



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## Department Maturity Assessment



Solid line: current state. Dashed line: target state (post-roadmap).

### **MENA & International Sales scores 2.0 overall —**

The vertical maintains a structured 2–4 month trial cycle, but pipeline tracking is entirely Google Sheets-driven with no CRM. The low Technology (1.5) and Knowledge Management (1.5) scores reflect the absence of automated remittance alerts and the risk of international relationships being tied to personal SIM cards.

Extending Zoho Books/CRM and securing existing WhatsApp/WeChat channels onto company-owned infrastructure will structurally stabilize the vertical without disrupting existing distributor relationships.

| DIMENSION                    | CURRENT    | TARGET     | GAP        |
|------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|
| Process Standardization      | 2.0        | 3.5        | 1.5        |
| Technology Utilization       | 2.0        | 3.0        | 1.0        |
| Data Quality & Accessibility | 2.0        | 3.0        | 1.0        |
| Documentation                | 2.0        | 3.0        | 1.0        |
| Knowledge Management         | 2.0        | 3.0        | 1.0        |
| <b>Overall</b>               | <b>2.0</b> | <b>3.1</b> | <b>1.1</b> |



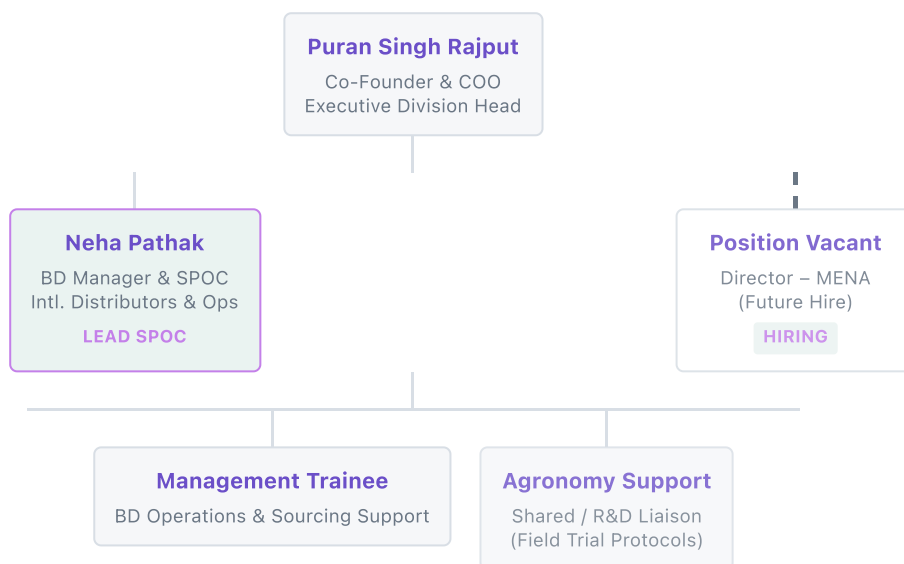
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## Team Structure

Reporting hierarchy within MENA Business (lean 2-person team: Neha + 1 Management Trainee). Neha Pathak currently reports directly to Puran Singh Rajput (Co-Founder & COO); a Director – MENA seat is open and will become her reporting line once hired (shown dashed).



## Tools in Use



### Google Sheets (Dual Trackers)

Manual Logistics Tracker (export shipment status) & Customer Stage Tracker (pipeline). No live sync between the two; updated reactively.



### Gmail

Primary formal correspondence for international distributors.



### Slack

Used specifically for Middle East real-time coordination.



### WeChat (Personal)

China distributor communications maintained via personal phone.



### WhatsApp (Personal)

Used for general coordination and manual payment warnings to Accounts.



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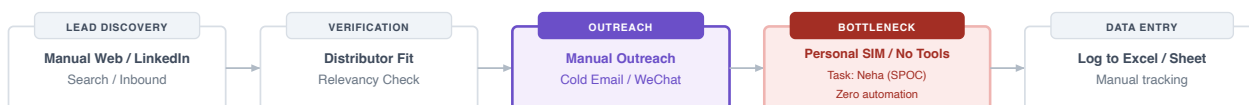
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## SECTION 03 — PROCESS DETAIL

# Current Workflows

Where each finding sits inside the operational process

## Outbound Lead Sourcing & Market Expansion — P-05



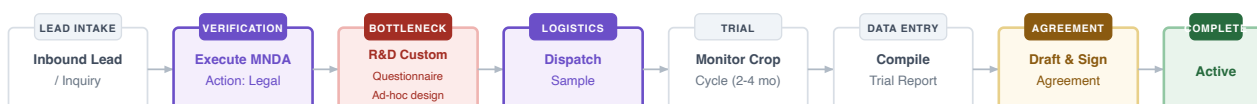
**What is good:** Direct personal outreach by Neha builds strong initial rapport with international distributor targets.

**What needs to be fixed:** Lead generation relies almost entirely on organic inbound queries and manual email/LinkedIn messages. No automated scraping, data enrichment, or targeted outbound tools (e.g. Apollo/Sales Navigator) are deployed.

**Bottlenecks:** Outbound expansion into new MENA and Asian regions is capped by manual outreach capacity. Zero automated nurturing exists for dormant prospects.

**Dependencies:** 100% dependent on Neha Pathak's personal daily bandwidth for lead discovery and follow-up.

## Client Onboarding & Trial Lifecycle — P-02



**What is good:** The trial lifecycle is comprehensive and logically sequenced. Indian dosage calculators are bypassed in favor of custom R&D parameters, ensuring scientific accuracy for international climates.

**What needs to be fixed:** Every trial requires ad-hoc R&D consultation. There is no standardized intake form for international trial requests, adding 3–5 back-and-forth emails per initiation.

**Bottlenecks:** The 2–4 month crop cycle is scientifically necessary, but the setup phase is artificially inflated by unstructured intake.

**Dependencies:** R&D must manually review and design parameters for every new international trial request received from Neha.

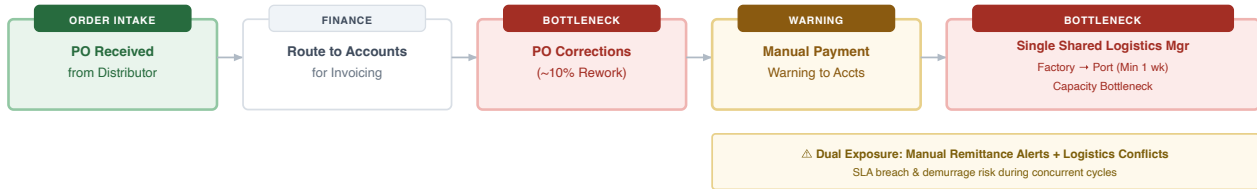


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## Commercial Order & Shipping — P-01 P-03



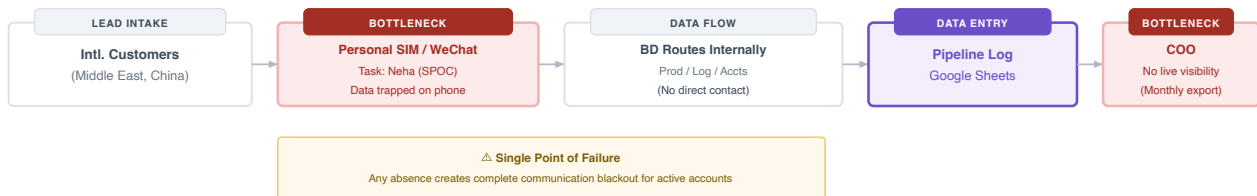
**What is good:** The PO completeness rate is high (~90%), requiring corrections on only 1 in 10 orders before invoicing.

**What needs to be fixed:** International payments do not trigger Zoho Books alerts. BD must manually warn Accounts before dispatch can proceed. Furthermore, export dispatch is routed to a Logistics Manager shared with domestic ops.

**Bottlenecks:** On international dispatch days, 100% of logistics capacity is consumed. This delays domestic orders and creates demurrage and SLA breach risk during peak export cycles.

**Dependencies:** Critical dependency on the Logistics Manager (shared resource) and Finance/Accounts for manual payment clearance.

## SPOC Communication Model & Data Risk — P-02 P-04



**What is good:** Routing through a SPOC maintains relationship quality and consistency for international distributors across time zones.

**What needs to be fixed:** Middle East and China accounts are maintained via a personal SIM and WeChat. There is no company-owned record of international contact relationships.

**Bottlenecks:** If Neha is unavailable, there is a complete communication blackout for all active accounts. Employee exit risks full loss of account contacts.

**Dependencies:** Internal teams (Production, Logistics, Accounts) are entirely dependent on Neha to relay customer context and trial updates.



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## APPENDIX

# Cross-Department Dependencies

Findings and recommendations that require action outside the MENA & International Sales vertical to resolve

## Logistics

### CRITICAL GATING — DISPATCH

#### OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

The Logistics Manager owns export dispatch windows and is shared with domestic operations. Priority routing for international shipments requires formal scheduling agreement.

 **Key Person: Nihal Paliwal (Logistics)**

#### CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

On international dispatch days, 100% of logistics capacity is consumed. Cannot be resolved by MENA alone; requires COO-level mandate for priority routing windows.

#### DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

Logistics must commit to updating the shared Dispatch Scheduler dashboard in real-time so MENA can track export status without phone calls.

## Finance & Accounts

### PAYMENT CLEARANCE

#### OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

Zoho Books notification configuration for cross-border payments requires Finance access. Dispatch clearance process must be updated.

 **Key Person: Shobha Shekhawat (Finance)**

#### CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

Currently, BD must manually warn Accounts before international dispatch can proceed. Preventable dispatch holds occur frequently.

#### DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

Accounts must update their SOP to rely on the automated Zoho Books API alert rather than the BD Manager's manual warning.



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## R&D & Enterprise IT

TRIAL INTAKE & CRM

### OPERATIONS DEPENDENCY

R&D must co-design the trial request form.  
Enterprise IT must scope the Custom React CRM rollout to include MENA's specific hierarchy.

 Key Persons: Ritu Panwar (R&D) / IT Head

### CRITICAL BOTTLENECK

Standalone CRM implementation by MENA would create data silos. R&D sign-off is needed before the trial intake form goes live.

### DATA TRANSFER & UPDATES NEEDED

R&D must define the exact crop/climate parameters required for international trial design. Enterprise IT must ensure the Custom React CRM integrates with the broader EF Polymer OS.





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## SECTION 04 — OPERATIONAL PAIN POINTS

# Pain Points Register

Ranked by operational impact. Each pain point is cross-referenced to its recommendation in Section 06.

### Priority Focus Areas:

- ① **Logistics & Remittance Friction** — The manual cross-border payment warning and shared logistics bottleneck expose international SLAs to failure risk during peak periods.
- ② **Pipeline & IP Visibility** — International client data is trapped on personal devices, and the pipeline is managed in Sheets with no live visibility for the COO.

|      | PAIN POINT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | IMPACT   | EVIDENCE FROM AUDIT                                                                                                                                                    |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P-01 | <b>Single-Point Logistics Constraint.</b> All international dispatches share one Logistics Manager with domestic and B2B operations. No export priority routing exists.                                                                                                 | CRITICAL | On international dispatch days, 100% of logistics capacity is consumed. Domestic orders are delayed; demurrage and SLA breach risk are high during peak export cycles. |
| P-02 | <b>No CRM or Structured Pipeline Tracking.</b> International distributor pipeline is managed entirely in Google Sheets with no stage-gating, deal history, or COO visibility.                                                                                           | CRITICAL | Pipeline status is opaque above SPOC level. No basis for revenue forecasting or distributor performance review. Excel tracker is updated manually.                     |
| P-03 | <b>No Automated Cross-Border Remittance Alerts.</b> International payments do not trigger notifications in Zoho Books; BD must manually warn Accounts before dispatch can proceed.                                                                                      | HIGH     | Manual advance warning required per shipment. Preventable dispatch holds occur with low-effort automation. Wastes ~30 min per shipment.                                |
| P-04 | <b>International Client Relationships on Personal Phone.</b> Middle East and China accounts are maintained via a personal SIM and WeChat — roughly <b>~90% of MENA business communications</b> run on these personal channels rather than company-owned infrastructure. | HIGH     | No company-owned record of international contact relationships. Full account contact list is at personal risk on employee exit.                                        |
| P-05 | <b>Missing Outbound Lead Generation Process.</b> Outbound lead gen relies on manual emails and LinkedIn messages. No automated scraping or targeted outreach tools are used.                                                                                            | MEDIUM   | Reliance on organic inbound queries limits pipeline growth and market expansion capacity into new regions.                                                             |



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## SECTION 05 — TIME & EFFORT

### Time & Effort Allocation

Estimated allocation for Neha Pathak (BD Manager), who acts as the sole SPOC for the vertical.

| ACTIVITY                                                             | SHARE OF TEAM TIME | EST. TIME / DAY |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------|
| Logistics & Export Execution Coordination (Manual dispatch tracking) | ~30%               | ~2.4 hrs        |
| Lead Qualification & Inbound Follow-up                               | ~25%               | ~2.0 hrs        |
| Trial Alignment & R&D Coordination (Ad-hoc questionnaires)           | ~20%               | ~1.6 hrs        |
| Contract Administration & Legal Routing                              | ~15%               | ~1.2 hrs        |
| Pipeline Logging & Tracker Updates (Google Sheets)                   | ~10%               | ~0.8 hrs        |

#### Key Observation:

Roughly **30% of the SPOC's time** is consumed by manual logistics and export execution coordination—work that should be handled by an integrated dispatch dashboard. Furthermore, an additional **10% is spent manually logging pipeline data** into disconnected Sheets, preventing strategic outbound growth.



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## SECTION 06 — CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

# Recommended Solution Segment

This section outlines the integrated technology solution proposed to resolve operational bottlenecks, replacing the legacy recommendations register. Built on the Solution Design Framework — extend existing Zoho Books/CRM, secure data on existing channels, integrate cross-departmentally.

## Implementation Required

### Solution Modules to be Built:

#### 1 Ops & Finance Automation (Integration)

- **Zoho Books API Alerts:** Configure automated cross-border payment notifications. When an international payment clears, Zoho Books triggers an alert directly to Accounts and Logistics via WhatsApp/Slack—eliminating manual BD warnings.
- **Logistics Dispatch Scheduler:** A shared dashboard module visualizing export vs. domestic dispatch capacity. Forces pre-scheduled export windows so international SLAs don't cannibalize domestic capacity.

#### 2 Secure Comms & Custom React CRM Pipeline

- **Virtual Business Number:** Transition Middle East and China comms from Neha's personal SIM/WeChat to a company-owned Virtual Business Line. Secures all contact IP against employee turnover.
- **Custom React CRM Integration:** Replace the Google Sheets pipeline tracker with the Custom React JS CRM (unified with other BD verticals for centralized data). Provides the COO with live deal-stage visibility and distributor performance tracking.

#### 3 Outbound & Trial Intake Infrastructure (Custom Build)

- **Standardized R&D Trial Form:** Structured digital intake (crop type, region, climate, target outcomes) replaces ad-hoc email consultations for every new international trial. Reduces per-trial setup time by ~40%.
- **Targeted Outbound Engine:** Implement automated lead scraping (Apollo/LinkedIn Sales Navigator) integrated with the CRM, paired with region-specific technical case studies to boost outbound conversion.



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### What Remains the Same

- **No New Finance Tool:** Zoho Books remains the system of record. We simply configure its native API alert rules.
- **Familiar Channels:** The team continues using WhatsApp/Slack/WeChat. The transition is backend (Personal → Company Virtual Line).

### Tech Stack Utilized

- **Frontend:** ReactJS + TypeScript (Dashboard)
- **APIs:** Zoho Books, Custom CRM, WhatsApp Business
- **AI:** Apollo / LinkedIn Sales Navigator
- **Host:** Google Cloud Platform

### Key Operational Problems Solved

- Eliminates manual payment warnings and dispatch holds via Zoho Books API integration.
- Secures 100% of international client data against employee turnover via Virtual Business Lines.
- Provides COO with live CRM pipeline visibility, replacing monthly manual Google Sheets updates.
- Accelerates trial setup by 40% through structured R&D intake forms, replacing ad-hoc email chains.

## Future Scope of Improvement / Enhancement

- **Dedicated Export Logistics Role:** If export volume scales beyond the capacity of the shared Logistics Manager, a dedicated export coordinator may be required. The Phase 1 dashboard will provide the data to justify this headcount.

## Next Steps for Team Adoption

- **SOP Update:** Accounts and Logistics must update their clearance SOPs to rely on the automated Zoho Books alert rather than Neha's manual warning.
- **CRM Training:** Neha must complete the Custom CRM walkthroughs. Adoption of the CRM is mandatory before outbound lead-gen tools are layered on.
- **Device Handoff:** Formalize the transition of international contacts to the company Virtual Business Line; personal numbers phased out.



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## SECTION 07 — IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

# Phased Roadmap

Initiatives sequenced across three phases, with quantified ROI and scope of work

| INITIATIVE                              |              | PHASE 1<br>WEEKS 1–4 | PHASE 2<br>WEEKS 5–9 | PHASE 3<br>WEEKS 10–12 |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|----------------------|------------------------|
| Zoho Books Payment Alerts & Virtual SIM | Module 1 & 2 | ●                    |                      |                        |
| Logistics Dispatch Scheduler & CRM      | Module 1 & 2 |                      | ●                    |                        |
| Outbound Engine & R&D Trial Form        | Module 3     |                      |                      | ●                      |

## Phase 1 — Quick Wins & Data Security

Weeks 1–4 · Zero technology cost

Maturity 2.0 → 2.4

### SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Configure Zoho Books cross-border payment notification rules for international receipts. Route alerts to Accounts and Logistics via WhatsApp/Slack.
- **Build:** Procure company SIM or activate virtual business number for BD Manager. Transfer active international WhatsApp and WeChat accounts.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** **Zoho Books API** **WhatsApp Business API** .
- **Client To-Do:** HR to formalize communication policy and device ownership rules.

**~30 min**

**SAVED / SHIPMENT**

Manual payment warning eliminated.

**100%**

**ACCOUNTS SECURED**

Intl. contacts protected against exit.



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## Phase 2 — Operational Foundation

Weeks 5–9 · CRM & Logistics Sync

Maturity 2.4 → 2.8

### SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Deploy Logistics Dispatch Scheduler dashboard. Negotiate and document pre-scheduled export dispatch windows.
- **Build:** Configure Custom React CRM: Company → Deal / Crop Account hierarchy. Migrate pipeline data from Google Sheets.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** [React.js Dashboard](#) [Custom CRM API](#) .
- **Client To-Do:** Logistics Manager to commit to priority routing windows; COO to define pipeline review cadence.

**O**

#### SLA BREACHES

Prevents logistics capacity conflicts.

**Live**

#### COO VISIBILITY

Replaces monthly manual Sheets export.

## Phase 3 — Outbound & Trial Intake

Weeks 10–12 · Scaling Pipeline

Maturity 2.8 → 3.1

### SCOPE OF WORK & DEPENDENCIES

- **Build:** Deploy standardized R&D trial request form (digital intake). Co-design with R&D Head to capture all international parameters.
- **Build:** Integrate Apollo / LinkedIn Sales Navigator with Custom React CRM. Create region-specific case studies for outbound targeting.
- **Tech Stack & Badges:** [Apollo API](#) [LinkedIn API](#) [Custom CRM API](#) .
- **Client To-Do:** R&D Head to sign off on trial intake fields; BD Manager to finalize target region list.

↓ **40%**

#### TRIAL SETUP TIME

Structured intake replaces email chains.

**Predictive**

#### OUTBOUND PIPELINE

Reduces reliance on organic inbound.



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Measurable improvements post-implementation

| CATEGORY                         | BEFORE (CURRENT STATE)                                                      | AFTER (POST-IMPLEMENTATION)                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cross-Border Payments</b>     | BD manually warns Accounts of international payments before dispatch.       | <b>Automated Zoho Books Alerts.</b> Payment clearance triggers instant WhatsApp/Slack alert to Accounts & Logistics.        |
| <b>Pipeline Tracking</b>         | Disconnected Google Sheets. No visibility for COO above SPOC level.         | <b>Custom React CRM Integration.</b> Live deal-stage visibility, distributor performance tracking, and automated reporting. |
| <b>Logistics Capacity</b>        | Single shared Logistics Manager. Export days cannibalize domestic capacity. | <b>Dispatch Scheduler Dashboard.</b> Pre-scheduled export windows eliminate SLA breaches and demurrage risk.                |
| <b>Client Data Security</b>      | Middle East & China accounts on personal SIM and WeChat.                    | <b>Virtual Business Lines.</b> Company-owned numbers secure 100% of contact IP against employee turnover.                   |
| <b>Trial Setup</b>               | Ad-hoc email consultations with R&D for every new international trial.      | <b>Standardized Intake Form.</b> Structured parameters reduce per-trial setup time by 40%.                                  |
| <b>Outbound Lead Gen</b>         | Manual emails and LinkedIn messages. High reliance on inbound.              | <b>Targeted Outbound Engine.</b> Apollo/LinkedIn scraping integrated with CRM; region-specific case studies.                |
| <b>Department Maturity Score</b> | 2.0 / 5.0 (Ad-hoc)                                                          | <b>3.1 / 5.0 (Systematised)</b>                                                                                             |



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## Quantified Executive Time Savings

Estimated annual bandwidth reclaimed for the MENA & International Sales Manager by automating payment notifications and trial intake.

|                                    |                                          |                                     |                                      |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>~30 min</b><br>SAVED / SHIPMENT | <b>40%</b><br>TRIAL SETUP<br>ACCELERATED | <b>12 hrs</b><br>MONTHLY TIME SAVED | <b>144 hrs</b><br>ANNUAL HOURS SAVED |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|

### Bandwidth Reinvestment Breakdown:

- **Current Friction:** Manager manually calls Accounts for international payment warnings before each export dispatch and relies on unstructured email threads for trial intake.
- **Automated Efficiency:** Automated Zoho Books API payment clearance triggers and standardized digital intake forms accelerate setup and remove manual warnings.
- **Strategic Impact:** Reclaims **144 BD hours per year (~18 full working days)** to expand international distributor partnerships across Middle East & EU markets.